The letter was also marked to Margaret Alva, minister of state for youth affairs and sports. Alva chaired a meeting between the central and the state governments on 23 March 1987 in which the state officials stressed the importance of national integration camps in Punjab to clear misconceptions about the government's intentions among the youth. An officer from Punjab also pointed out that positive media coverage could be an important aspect of the effort.

Alva mentioned during the meeting that it was not only necessary to take youth from Punjab to other parts of the country, but it was equally necessary to take youth from other parts of the country to Punjab so that they could have a balanced view of the development of the country.

Prime Minister Gandhi chaired a meeting on 11 November 1987 at Room No. 9, Parliament House, where Punjab's governor Siddhartha Shankar Ray was also present. Gandhi indicated that the state government should come forward with concrete proposals within two weeks, which could then be considered in the central government ministries concerned. Ray had submitted a note to the prime minister on behalf of the state government and it categorically said that the youth in Punjab was being buffeted by a separatist ideology based on fundamentalism and obscurantism. The need of the hour was, therefore, to inculcate and foster a nationalistic ideology based on secularism, democracy and rule of law and to disseminate this ideology throughout the social spectrum. The Punjab government believed that it needed to establish an intimate and direct relationship between the youth and the community, by involving them in need based programmes for rural reconstruction during or soon after their graduation. Such activities, the state government argued, had successfully been